BUILD6™

WEEK 12 · Communication Under Pressure

Michelle Boudin - Think. Respond. Recover.

FACILITATOR GUIDE

Week Purpose

Build interview, presentation, panel, conflict, media and workplace communication skills by practicing how to think, respond, recover and stay credible under pressure.

Essential Question

How do I think, respond, recover, and remain credible when the pressure is real?

Skills

- Camera presence
- Interview communication
- Panel discussion
- Conflict response
- Pressure recovery
- Concise answers
- Active listening
- Body language
- Credibility

Weekly Rhythm

Monday · Catch-Up + Pressure Awareness

Finish missing work and identify your pressure reactions, presence, listening habits, body language, voice, and one communication goal.

Facilitator note: Monday is primarily catch-up, accountability and discussion. Do not overload it with new instruction.

- What happens to my communication under pressure?
- What makes someone look/sound credible?
- Prepared vs. scripted - what is the difference?
- One habit I want to improve

Tuesday · Camera Lab

Practice a 30-second introduction, explain something simply, answer an unexpected question, receive one coaching point and retry immediately.

- My 30-second introduction
- First-attempt observation
- Coaching point
- What changed on my second attempt?

Wednesday · Pressure + Conflict + Panel Lab

Practice difficult questions, disagreement, interruption, blanking, criticism, correcting misinformation, saying 'I don't know' professionally, and rotating panel roles.

Facilitator note: Run the activity exactly enough that students practice, receive feedback, and can explain what they learned.

- A difficult question I answered
- How I disagreed without becoming defensive
- How I handled not knowing
- What I learned as panelist / interviewer / moderator / observer
- My best recovery phrase

Thursday · Michelle Boudin Live Application

Apply camera/interview/panel skills with professional coaching and immediate retry.

- My specific goal
- Feedback I received
- What changed on retry
- How this transfers to interviews, presentations, meetings, conflict or leadership

Friday · Before / After Communication Artifact

Write a thank-you, compare first and later attempts, identify strongest answer and next improvement goal.

Facilitator note: Finish missing work first, then reflection, thank-you/follow-up when appropriate, and portfolio/capstone evidence.

- Before: what pressure did to my communication
- After: what I now do differently
- My strongest communication moment
- What I still need to practice
- Thank-you message for Michelle

Coach Jones - Wednesday Run of Show

1. First Take / Coach / Second Take - Students respond on camera or on stage, receive one precise coaching note, then immediately retry.

2. Unexpected Question Round - Students answer short unscripted questions without rushing or overexplaining.

3. Pressure + Conflict Lab - Students practice disagreement, correction, criticism, interruption and professional boundaries.

4. Panel Hot Seat - Students rotate panelist, interviewer, moderator and observer roles with curveball questions.

Facilitator Questions

- What did you notice?
- What changed after feedback or a second attempt?
- Where would this matter in a real workplace?
- What decision did the student own instead of outsourcing?
- What evidence should be saved for portfolio or capstone?

Midweek Reflection

What pressure reaction did I notice in myself, and what recovery technique helped me remain credible?

Friday Reflection

What changed between my first attempt and my later attempt, and what will I deliberately practice next?

Capstone Connection

Preserve a before/after communication example: what pressure did to your first attempt, the feedback you received, what you changed, and evidence that your second attempt was stronger.